

VIRGINIA SPACEPORT AUTHORITY · LIVE TRAINING

# Microsoft 365 Copilot at Work

Making Copilot work for you.

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SESSION A · 60 MINUTES

# Prompting & Copilot Chat

Get real answers from your own documents - reliably.





## SESSION A · THE SCENARIO

# Monday at the spaceport

Campaign MERIDIAN is two weeks from its window. The reading pile doesn't care.



**48-page safety policy** - updated Friday - you must know what changed



**Ops status report** - leadership wants the short version



**90 minutes** - before your next meeting

# What is Microsoft 365 Copilot?

Three ideas, and the rest of the hour makes sense.



## AI + your content

A language model reasons over your prompt plus the documents you give it.



## Inside your apps

Chat, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote  
- where you already work.



## Directed in English

No syntax. You describe the outcome; it drafts, you decide.

# What can Copilot do for you?



## **Generate**

Drafts, emails, briefs - and images too. Blank page, gone.



## **Summarize**

48 pages into 5 bullets. Long threads into decisions.



## **Compare**

Two versions, three proposals, old policy vs new - side by side.



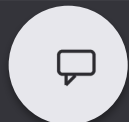
## **Analyze**

A spreadsheet becomes insights, outliers, and formulas.



## **Rewrite**

Same content, new audience: shorter, simpler, more formal.



## **Answer**

Ask questions about YOUR documents - with citations.





## SESSION A · THE APP

# Meet the Copilot app - home base

One app, three doors. Same Copilot behind all of them.



**On the web** - m365.cloud.microsoft - works everywhere



**Inside Teams** - the Copilot app in your left rail



**On Windows** - the Microsoft 365 Copilot app

# The prompt box - your cockpit



## The + button

Attach files - your grounding superpower. Word, Excel, PDFs.



## Suggestion chips

Files, Emails, People, Meetings - one-tap starting points as rollout matures.



## Just type

Plain language. No syntax, no commands to memorize.



## New chat, new topic

One conversation per task keeps answers sharp.

# Effective Copilot use - in and out



## Quality in

- Ask with all four GCSE elements
- Ground it - give it your sources
- Iterate - refine in conversation



## Vetted out

- Verify receipts and numbers
- Traffic-light before you act
- You own everything you send



The whole course in five beats: what it CAN do → GCSE → GROUND it → VET it → SAVE what works.



# The four elements · G C S E

Every strong prompt has these. Weak prompts are missing one.



## Goal

The deliverable. 'Draft a one-page leadership brief.'



## Context

Who it's for, why now. 'For the executive director, pre-launch.'



## Source

Ground it - attach the file. 'Using the attached status report.'



## Expectations

Format, length, tone. 'Five bullets, plain language, no jargon.'

# Simple to best - add one at a time

**01**

## **Goal**

'Summarize the new safety policy.'

>

**02**

## **+ Context**

'...for ops staff who knew the old one.'

>

**03**

## **+ Source**

'...using the attached policy document.'

>

**04**

## **+ Expectation**

'5 bullets on what changed, plain language.'

# Iterate - don't start over



## Re-aim it

'Rewrite this for the executive director, not ops staff.'



## Restructure it

'Reorganize as: summary, 3 changes, risks, effective dates.'



## Cut it

'Keep only the top 3 items by operational impact.'



## Tighten it

'Remove any sentence without a decision, number, or action.'

# Your chats stick around



## Pick up where you left

Yesterday's thread is in the left rail - continue it, don't restart.



## Name the keepers

Rename chats you'll return to: 'Budget prep', 'Policy questions'.



## Context carries

Follow-ups remember the conversation - iterate without re-explaining.

# Pick your speed



## Auto

The default. Copilot picks the right engine for the task - leave it here.



## Quick response

Fast answers for simple asks - summaries, rewrites, lookups.



## Think Deeper

Slower, stronger reasoning - comparisons, risk analysis, hard tradeoffs.



Don't see the picker? It's rolling out - Auto behavior is the default either way.

# Grounding - give Copilot the fuel



## **Answers mix four sources**

What the model knows, what it can reach, what you hand it, and the web. Grounding is choosing well.



## **What the model knows**

Built-in general knowledge. Fine for common ground - a fabrication risk for YOUR facts and figures.



## **OneDrive & SharePoint**

Files stored there are reachable sources - point Copilot at them.



## **Attach file(s)**

The surest ground: Copilot reads every word of what you give it. This move powers everything today.



## **Your content, not the open web**

Web results are off in your environment - your documents carry the day, and uploads cover the rest.



One habit, five apps - the attach move works in Chat, Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook.



# How Copilot builds an answer

**01**

## **Your prompt**

You ask in plain language inside the app.



**02**

## **It grounds**

It reads the files you attached or opened.



**03**

## **You review**

You get a draft - check it, then decide.

# Grounding and the receipt



## Your permissions

Copilot only sees what you can already open. Nothing more.



## Citations

Grounded answers point at their source. Click it. Check it.



## Verify the claim

Numbers, names, dates - confirm against the document before it leaves you.



Treat every output as a first draft from a fast, confident junior analyst.

# 48 pages to 5 bullets - with receipts



## LIVE DEMO

- 1** Level-1 prompt, then build to full GCSE
- 2** Click a citation - verify against the page
- 3** Follow-up: launch-day staffing question
- 4** KEEP IT: bookmark the prompt · send to a Page

# Keep the prompt - the Gallery



## Open it

New chat, then the ... under the message box - proven prompts by task and role.



## Save your winners

Hover over a prompt you've already run - click the bookmark icon. Kept.



## Share the team's

One person's discovery becomes everyone's speed.

# Create - the design studio



## Images from words

Describe it: an image, infographic, poster, or banner  
- refine in conversation.



## Edit an image

Bring one you have; change it by describing the change.



## My images

Everything you've generated, collected right here under Create.



Generated images live here under My images - not in Library. Library is for Pages.

# Find it again: Search vs Library



## Search

- Hunt across your chats
- Find that answer from last week
- Reach your work content



## Library

- Your Pages in one place
- Living documents - edit and share
- Reopen and continue any Page



A great answer deserves promotion: send it to a Page - editable, shareable, alive.

# Agents & Notebooks - a look ahead



## Researcher

Deep multi-step research over your content - assign it a question, get a report.



## Analyst

Data analysis in chat - reads your spreadsheets, reasons about numbers.



## Notebooks

Pin a project's sources; Copilot answers from only those files.



Availability follows your license and rollout - when these light up, today's prompting skills drive them.

# Validate before you ship - 4 checks

**01**

## **The receipt**

Open a citation;  
confirm it  
matches.



**02**

## **The numbers**

Figures, names,  
dates vs source.



**03**

## **The sources**

'List your source  
per claim.'



**04**

## **The gaps**

'What does this  
leave out?'



# Three tells worth a second look



## Suspiciously round

Numbers that feel too clean - verify against the source table.



## Receipt won't click

A citation that doesn't open or doesn't match - stop and check.



## Beyond the document

Claims about things your attached file never mentions - ask where it came from.

# The traffic light - then act



## **Green - use it**

Receipts click, numbers match, nothing invented. Ship it.



## **Yellow - adjust**

Right shape, soft spots. Fix the prompt - usually add Source - and re-run.



## **Red - re-ground**

Claims beyond the document or receipts that don't hold. Start a fresh, grounded ask.



Most yellows are a missing Source. Attach the file and the light usually turns green.

# Paste these to pressure-test

## What you're practicing

- Make Copilot show its work
- Anchor every claim to the document
- Surface its own uncertainty
- Hunt the gaps before your reader does

## PASTE THIS

“

List your source for each claim in that answer - one line per claim.

“

Quote the exact sentence from the attached document that supports [claim].

“

What in this answer are you least confident about, and why?

# Break it on purpose - then catch it



## LIVE DEMO

- 1 Ask the policy doc something it never covers
- 2 Watch the answer - honest gap or confident guess?
- 3 Demand the quote: 'exact sentence, please'
- 4 Re-ground and re-ask - watch it self-correct

# Status report to leadership brief



## LIVE DEMO

- 1 Attach Launch\_Campaign\_Status.docx
- 2 Full GCSE prompt - one-page leadership brief
- 3 Iterate: re-aim to the board, then cut to 3 items
- 4 Tighten: decisions, numbers, actions only

# Paste these into Copilot Chat

## What you're practicing

- Attach the file - always
- Name the audience and format
- Iterate with the four verbs
- Verify one citation every time

## PASTE THIS

“

Summarize the attached [policy/report] for [audience]: 5 bullets on what changed, plain language, include section numbers.

“

Using the attached report, draft a one-page brief for [leader]: progress, top 3 risks with owners, decisions needed this week.

“

Remove any sentence without a decision, a number, or an action.

# Your take-home kit



## The VSA Prompt Packet

Every prompt from today, 38 total, brackets for your own work.



## Art & Science of Prompting

Microsoft's 2-page field guide: prompt types by task, and how to keep the conversation going.



## Practice files + the story

Campaign MERIDIAN's documents - run any packet prompt against them.



All three: [github.com/scottrhay/vsacopilot](https://github.com/scottrhay/vsacopilot) - drop the link in chat now.

# Three moves the pros use



## Borrow an expert voice

'Act as a range safety officer reviewing this...' - the persona sets depth, vocabulary and blind spots.



## Let it interview you

'Interview me one question at a time to build the best prompt for [task].'



## Self-critique

'Critique your answer and rewrite it better.' The second draft usually wins.



All three work in your environment today - no special features needed.



# Borrow an expert voice - openers

## Why personas work

- A role brings its vocabulary and depth
- Different experts catch different risks
- Stretch: review as your toughest reader
- Combine with GCSE - persona is Context

## PASTE THIS

“

Act as a [range safety officer / contracts specialist / communications director].  
Review the attached document and flag what your role would catch.

“

You are a skeptical executive reviewer.  
What three questions would you ask before approving this?

# Your first ten minutes



# Three lines to keep

“

If it matters, attach the file.

“

GCSE: Goal, Context, Source, Expectations.

“

First answer is a draft - iterate, then verify.

# Questions - and your first prompt

## Before you log off

Pick ONE prompt from the packet and run it on a real document today. That's the whole assignment.

## Coming up

Session B at 4:00 - Copilot in Teams & Outlook: your inbox, triaged.



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## APPENDIX

# Your environment reference

The availability map - July 2026.



# Use today - and what's next

| USE TODAY                                 | NOT YET AVAILABLE HERE         |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Chat with attached files</b>           | Enterprise-wide chat grounding |
| <b>Word: grounded drafts, rewrites</b>    | PPT auto-create, speaker notes |
| <b>PPT &amp; Word: summarize, tighten</b> | Teams: recap and chat Copilot  |
| <b>Outlook: summarize, draft, coach</b>   | Outlook: Schedule with Copilot |
| <b>Excel: formulas, explain, what-if</b>  | Excel: Python and automation   |
| <b>OneNote: summaries, actions</b>        | Edge sidebar; web grounding    |